



UPDATED
NOVEMBER 4, 2010



Working together to enhance safety, reduce congestion and maximize economic development along the US Highway 169 inter-regional corridor.

- US 169 Corridor Coalition Mission Statement

A Corridor Supporting Key Businesses



Cenex Harvest States Oilseed in Mankato



Cargill in Savage



Canterbury Park in Shakopee



Seagate in Bloomington / Shakopee



Mystic Lake Casino in Prior Lake



Cambria in Le Sueur

A Corridor Supporting Higher Education



Normandale Community College, Bloomington



Gustavus Adolphus College, St. Peter



Minnesota State University, Mankato



Hennepin Technical College, Eden Prairie



A Corridor that Moves Freight

Southwest Minnesota Freight traffic has the potential to grow 200 percent by 2030 if the current agricultural trends continue, which is double the statewide rate.



Commodity	Annual Tonnage, Total for Commodity
Foods and Agricultural Products	890,179
Concrete & Stone	293,384
Printed Material	42,678
Fabricated Metals: STCC Code 34	27,230
Paper & Products	35,832
Rubber & Misc. Plastics	19,741
Primary Metal	8,658
Misc. Manufactured Products	6,112

Southwest Minnesota Freight Study
Final Report, September 2007, Mn/DOT



A Corridor that Moves Freight



US 169 is considered a key freight corridor, from Mankato to the Twin Cities for the movement of small grains to the Ports of Savage – a nationally prominent port for the shipment of small grain and other agricultural commodities to the rest of the world.



The growth of freight traffic is being matched by growth in vehicle sizes: on the farms, the roads, and the rails, in response to the need for more efficiency and capacity. This not only further extends the demands placed on the current infrastructure that has seen little improvement in design and load carrying ability during the past decades, but carries with it many much-needed safety improvement considerations.



A Corridor that Supports Agriculture

- Wheat
- Corn
- Soybeans
- Hogs
- Milling and Food Processing
- Non-metallic Minerals – High Grade Silica Sand in Le Sueur County



A Corridor that Transports Energy

Ethanol and Biodiesel Fuel Plants:



- In 2006, the value added from local ethanol production and effects of higher grain prices directly and indirectly added approximately \$5 billion to Minnesota's economy.
- The average ethanol plant production is growing from 40 million gallons to 100 million gallons per year and has only 10 days of on-site storage for corn. As a result, ethanol production facilities rely on regular truck shipments (mostly fully loaded semis) from area farms for much of their supply.
- In 2005, shipments for Mn/DOT's Mankato/Windom District 7 totaled half of Minnesota's Ethanol Output
- Distiller Dried Grains (an ethanol byproduct), serve as a livestock feed that substitutes for grain meals, and has become an important area export commodity has now found a niche in international markets.
- Minnesota Municipal Power Association (MMPA) in Le Sueur plans construction of a BioPower facility using plant and animal waste materials to produce electricity.

Wind Energy



- Current importation of foreign wind turbine components may soon be matched by the production and export of domestic wind turbine components. Regional retail distribution centers will be established in the area to market wind turbine components.
- Southern Minnesota experience climatic patterns that are very supportive of wind turbine installations and electric generation.
- The Minnesota Department of Employment and Economic Development reported in a recent study that Mn/DOT District 7 is a likely candidate for one or more new wind turbine manufacturing plants. This will radically increase the number of truck transport trips being hosted by the District's roadway network. Any consideration of this new traffic must also account for truck and rail deliveries of the plant's raw materials and sub-components.

A Vision for a Key Commuter Corridor

The Union Pacific Railroad which is a parallel to US 169, provides a potential future Commuter Rail line from Mankato to Minneapolis.

January 13, 2010 – The Free Press
Rail plan explained in North Mankato

Prediction: Twin Cities to Mankato in six to 10 years

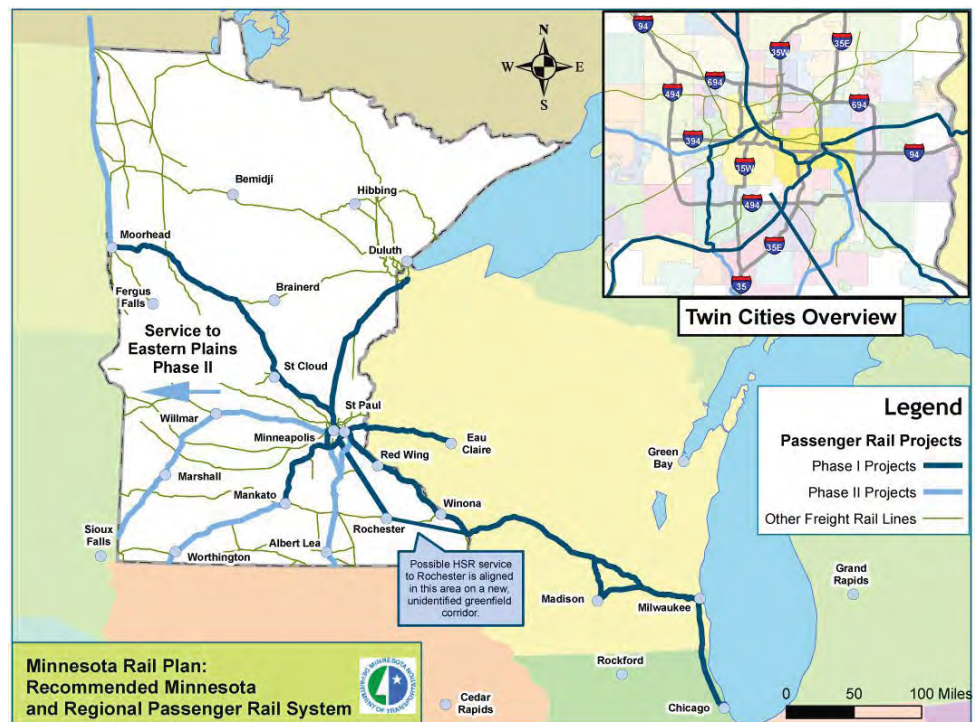


© Jason Verly

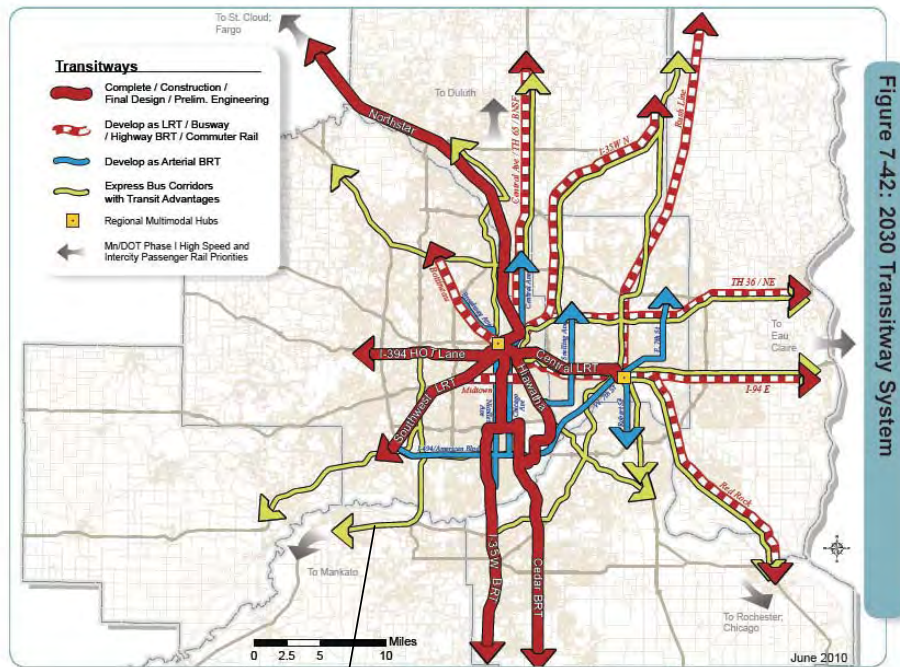
Union Depot, Mankato - photo credit- Jason Verly

* Projected 2030 Annual Passenger Rail Demand Twin Cities-Mankato
Base Case 228,000 trips (5.6% of total demand)
Best Case 340,000 trips (8.4% of total model demand)

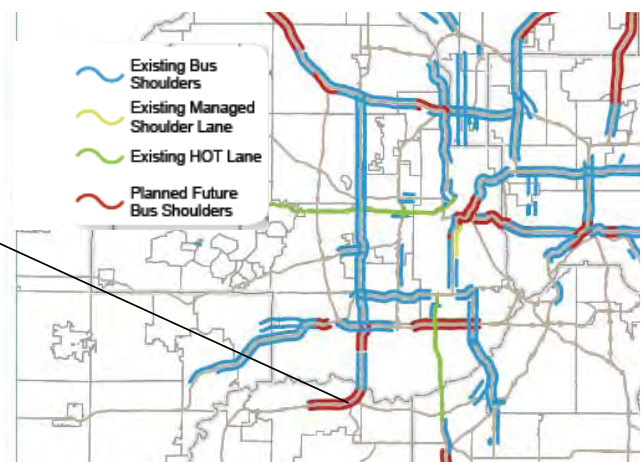
* Minnesota Comprehensive Statewide Freight and Passenger Rail Plan- 2010



A Vision for a Key Commuter Corridor



US 169



Source: "DRAFT Regional 2030 Transportation Policy Plan", 8-23-2010, Metropolitan Council

Corridor Coalition's Recent Success

I-494/US 169 Interchange Reconstruction

Construction Beginning 2011



Source: Mn/DOT "Performance Design" Conceptual Layout

The US-169/I-494 interchange is one of the most significant bottlenecks in the southwest metro resulting in higher than average crash and severity rates and significant daily motorist delay. To avoid congestion, many motorists cut through local streets.

The redesign and reconstruction of this interchange has been in and out of Mn/DOT's plan for years as priorities shifted due to decreasing metropolitan funding levels.

However, the coalition relentlessly advocated the need to prioritize this critical improvement project and as a result the project was elevated as a major metropolitan transportation improvement with dedicated funding. The redesign is in process and the procurement for construction is expected in the Fall of 2010. Construction is expected to begin in the Spring of 2011.



I-494 Westbound at US-169
Source: Mn/DOT

Community Benefits

- Removal of the last bottleneck along this heavily used regional arterial.
- Relieving the congestion would encourage commuters to stay on the major arterials, rather than using local Bloomington, Eden Prairie and Edina Streets.

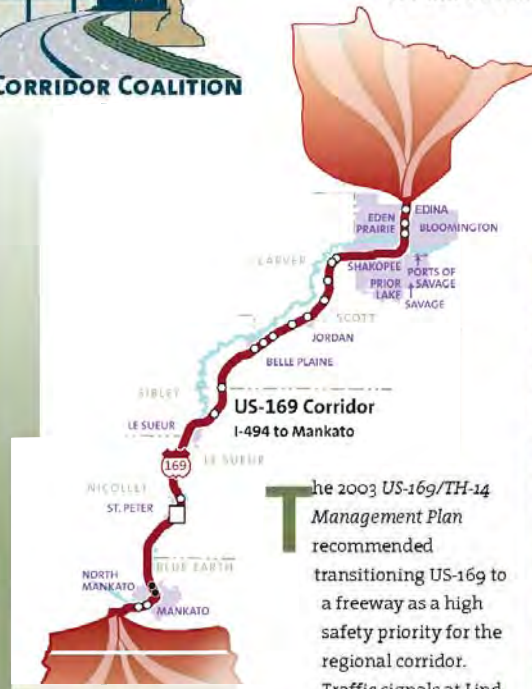
Construction Cost - \$125 million

Corridor Coalitions Key Project Priorities



TH-14 INTERCHANGE

SAFETY IMPROVEMENTS ARE A TOP PRIORITY



The 2003 US-169/TH-14 Management Plan recommended transitioning US-169 to a freeway as a high safety priority for the regional corridor.

Traffic signals at Lind Street and Webster Avenue will be replaced with interchanges. The likely location for a grade separation are just north of Webster Avenue to north of TH-14. Frontage roads will connect from parallel routes in North Mankato into Mankato to service the Lind St. commercial area.

An efficiency study of the Lind/Webster local traffic concept adjoining the interchange was implemented and analyzed in 2003. Studies determined that 70 percent of the traffic serviced by the local changes when compared to the current access system were significantly improved by this concept. Access provided by grade separation enhanced commercial activities adjoining the highway. The connection to Center Street in North Mankato resulted in improved access to a significant portion of lower North Mankato developments.

Since the original concept was developed in 1996, the City of Mankato has made improvements in all four quadrants of the intersection. The Minnesota Department of Transportation (MnDOT) has purchased rights-of-way needed in the Northeast quadrant under an emergency purchase and jointly shared it with the City of Mankato park development. The City of North Mankato has approved certain improvements in the Center Street/Webster area in anticipation of the closure of the Webster crossover and signal system.



COMMUNITY BENEFITS

- Two signal systems that are prone to accidents from slow-moving traffic conflicting with high-speed US-169 corridor vehicles will be removed.
- The changes will separate local commercial activities, while providing access to US-169/TH-14 through a ramp design rather than right-angle signal design.

FUNDING

Estimated cost: \$58 million.

Funding sources include the Federal Transportation Bill and MnDOT.

QUESTIONS

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Corridor Coalitions Key Project Priorities



TH-41/CSAH-78 INTERCHANGE

FUNDING NEEDED TO IMPROVE SAFETY AND MOBILITY ON US-169

This interchange has been identified as a key crossing along the US-169 Corridor. This US-169 intersection currently provides critical access to the existing TH-41, the principal arterial river crossing into northern Carver County, and to CSAH-78, the east-west principal arterial for central Scott County. According to the *New River Crossing (TH-41) DEIS*, traffic is projected to approach 50,000 vehicles per day on US-169, 40,000 vehicles per day on TH-41, and more than 20,000

vehicles per day on CSAH-78 under the freeway/river crossing/no build alternative design in the year 2030. With a new river crossing not funded, it is critical that the existing TH-41/CSAH-78 and US-169 intersection be reconstructed as an interchange. At the time of the new river crossing construction, projected volumes will still warrant a four-lane river crossing for local access needs.

The design and construction of the interchange should be coordinated with the preferred alignment of the regional river crossing project so that implementation of the future freeway connection will be achieved without the need for costly reconstruction of infrastructure.

COMMUNITY BENEFITS

- The design, environmental documentation and an interchange management plan will guide development in the interchange area and assist with further right-of-way preservation for the future interchange and needed supporting road network.
- Construction of an interchange would improve safety on the corridor by removing an at-grade signalized intersection.
- The mobility of the US-169 Corridor will improve.
- The interchange will serve a planned employment center in Scott County.
- This interchange will provide an important connection to US-169 for the CSAH-42 corridor via CSAH-78. CSAH-42 is a major arterial serving the east/west mobility needs

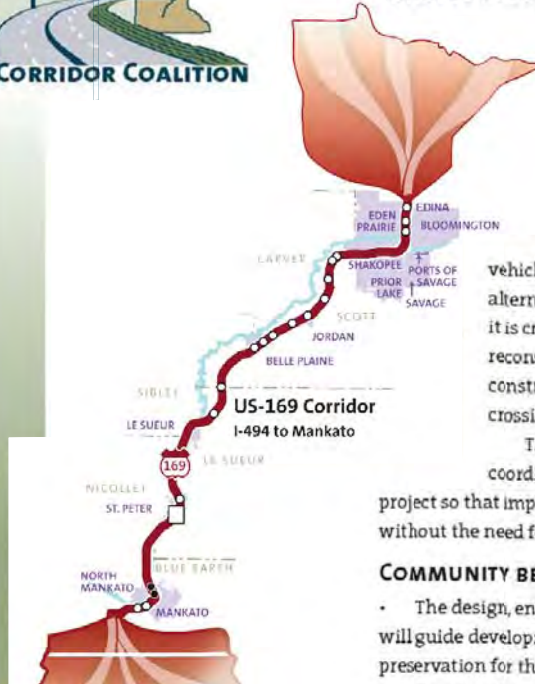
of the south Metro area connecting I-35W, TH-77, US-52 and US-61.

FUNDING

Estimated design/study cost: \$600,000.

Estimated construction/ rights-of-way cost: \$45 million.

An approved geometric layout, environmental documentation, right-of-way preservation and interchange management should be planned and developed through coordinated efforts. Official mapping by MnDOT should be required.



QUESTIONS

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Join Our Mission



Through your support and financial contribution the coalition can continue to spread the word about the economic significance that this corridor provides for its communities, businesses, and citizens. There is strength in numbers! As a business and citizen led coalition we can have an impact in making the policy and decision makers aware of our area's critical transportation needs. We have had our successes in obtaining the financial obligation for improving components of this corridor but our job is not nearly finished. The US 169 Coalition needs your support!

Affiliate Members: Your Support is Crucial

Affiliate Members are members of the community - businesses and individuals - who share in the Coalition's vision for the future of the Highway 169 corridor. The addition of your voice will send a strong message in support of improvements to the Highway 169 Corridor. Suggested contribution levels for Affiliate Members are as follows:

Business/Organizational Level

- Platinum Level: \$5,000 and above. At this level, members are invited to display their business or organization's logo on the Coalition website.
- Gold Level: \$1,000.
- Silver Level: \$500.
- Bronze Level: \$250.

Individual Level

- Special Level: \$25.

Please help build our message about the importance of these improvements by joining the Coalition as an Affiliate Member.

To join please visit: <http://www.us169corridorcoalition.com/>

